

British *Do*: v-Stranding Ellipsis?

Alex Silk

a.silk@bham.ac.uk

Draft of June 2025

This paper examines the “British *do*” construction, illustrated in (1) (Baker 1984, Oger 2019, Thoms 2019: 1032–1038).¹ Following a finite auxiliary with a nonfinite form of *do* in verb phrase ellipsis is ungrammatical in American English.

- (1) a. Alice will bring snacks, and Bert will **do**, too.
b. I’m not sure if Alice brought snacks, but she may have **done**.

A prominent approach has been to analyze British *do* as realizing “little v” (Chalcraft 2006, Haddican 2007, Aelbrecht 2010, Thoms 2011, Baltin 2012, Thoms & Sailor 2018, Griffiths & den Dikken 2022) — the head in the extended projection of the verb phrase that marks the verbal environment.² However, previous arguments for this conclusion are inconclusive; they fail to exclude a previously unexplored hypothesis that British *do* realizes Voice (also written *v**) (§§1–2). I present new experimental evidence from voice mismatches and argument structure mismatches which supports treating British *do* ellipsis as eliding VP (§3). Alternative analyses of British *do* in v versus Voice are reconsidered in this light. British *do* ellipsis and light-verb-stranding ellipsis in Persian are briefly compared (§4). §5 concludes.

1 British *Do* as v?

I begin by reviewing arguments for locating British *do* in v. First, in (1b) we see *do* follow *may* and perfective *have*. This provides evidence that British *do* is under aspectual auxiliaries (cf. Aelbrecht 2010: 196). From the other direction, examples such as (2) suggest that British *do* isn’t a main verb V (cf. Stroik 2001: 364–365; see also Embick & Noyer 2001, Haddican 2007). As the antecedent of the *wh* object of

¹All examples use British English unless indicated otherwise. In what follows I will use ‘British *do*’ as shorthand for British English *do* in the British *do* construction. As is common in this literature, I use ‘British (English)’ broadly to include dialects across the British Isles. Thanks to Alice Corr, Amit Ginbar, Terry Goetz, Anya Saliy, Sascha Sturgeon, Gary Thoms, and the indomitable Amelia Combes for discussion and assistance with the data.

²I examine the theoretical role(s) posited for v shortly.

do is a VP predicate (*buy candy*), the phrase headed by *do* must be larger than such a predicate, i.e. larger than VP.

(2) Bert might buy candy, which he shouldn't do.

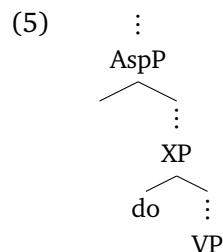
Further evidence that British *do* is above VP comes from examples with extraction of VP-internal arguments. For instance, in (3) British *do* co-occurs with an unaccusative configuration (cf. Baltin 2012: 388; see also Chalcraft 2006, Aelbrecht 2010, Thoms 2011, 2019, Baltin 2012, Thoms & Sailor 2018). Suppose, following Perlmutter 1983, Burzio 1986, and much subsequent work, that the derived subject *Alice/Bert* originates as an internal argument of unaccusative *fall* inside VP. *Bert* must be present in the ellipsis site so as to raise (eventually) into subject position and be pronounced, as reflected in (4).³

(3) Alice might fall, and Bert might do, too.

(4) Alice₁ might [_{VP} fall *t*₁], and Bert₂ might do [_{VP} fall *t*₂], too.

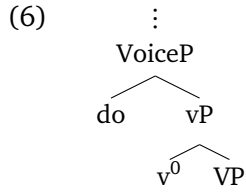
British *do* is above the (elided) VP in which the pronounced subject originates.

Such data have been used as evidence that British *do* is under the position of aspectual auxiliaries and above VP, as reflected in (5).



It is common to identify XP with vP and assume that British *do* is in v (Chalcraft 2006, Haddican 2007, Aelbrecht 2010, Thoms 2011, Baltin 2012, Thoms & Sailor 2018, Griffiths & den Dikken 2022). However, an alternative hypothesis is that British *do* realizes Voice—the head above v in the extended projection of the verb—as reflected in (6).

³I will assume an analysis of British *do* involving ellipsis and deletion of the material that goes unpronounced. Extraction examples such as (3) raise difficulties for analyses of British *do* as a deficient proform that lacks internal structure (as in Haddican 2007). See Thoms 2019, Griffiths & den Dikken 2022, Lewis 2022 for further discussion on British *do* and extraction. See e.g. Aelbrecht 2010, Merchant 2013 on how the derived subject comes to escape the ellipsis and be pronounced.



Such an analysis has not been previously considered. Yet it should not be dismissed out of hand. The next section first briefly outlines the assumed three-layered V-v-Voice structure for verb phrases. I then consider several *prima facie* advantages of analyzing British *do* in Voice, and in particular as realizing an active Voice head.

2 British *Do* as (Active) Voice?

It is common in light of substantial morphosyntactic and semantic evidence to analyze the verb phrase as a sequence of layered projections.⁴ In addition to the lexical verb *V* (or root $\sqrt{\text{ }}$), the literature distinguishes projections of an element *v*, which marks the verbal environment, and Voice (or *v*^{*}), which closes off the verb phrase and, in a phase-based syntax (Chomsky 2001, 2008), marks the edge of the verbal phase. In (7) the verb ‘work’ is overtly decomposed into a lexical core, here *barg*, and verbalizing element *v*, /a/. Voice morphology may also be overt, as in (8) (Hiaki is head-final).

- (7) a. *bargu* ‘work’ (n.)
 b. *bargat* ‘work’ (v.) (Julien 2015: 6; North Sámi (Uralic))
- (8) a. Aman kari-te-wa.
 there house-v⁰-PASS
 ‘Houses are being built there.’ (Harley 2013: 53; Hiaki (Uto-Aztecan))
 b.
-
- ```

 VoiceP
 / \
 vP Voice_{pass}
 / \ |
 kari v^0 -wa
 |
 -te

```

While not uncontroversial, I will follow Baltin (2012) and many others in the present literature and assume the three-layered architecture in what follows. I assume, in particular, that (i) there are projections of both *v* and Voice; (ii) *v* marks the verbal

<sup>4</sup>For an overview and references, see Harley 2017; also Pylkkänen 2008, Baltin 2012, Silk 2021.

environment and hosts heads introducing (e.g.) agentive, stative semantics; and (iii) Voice heads the verbal phase and hosts active/passive voice heads.

Analyzing British *do* in Voice has several features. First, it provides a new explanation of the observed incompatibility of British *do* with passive *be*.<sup>5</sup>

- (9) \*John might be visited by Sally, and Fred might be done\_\_\_\_, too.  
(Baltin 2012: ex. 20a)

Suppose that British *do* realizes an active Voice head. Its incompatibility with passive *be* follows from its featural specification.

Second, a distinguishing feature of British *do* is its compatibility with various types of antecedents (Baker 1984, Haddican 2007, Aelbrecht 2010, Oger 2019). In (10)–(12) we see British *do* occur with agentive, non-agentive dynamic, and stative antecedents, and in transitive, unaccusative, and unergative configurations.

- (10) Magneto/A hurricane would destroy the town, and Joker/a tornado might do, too.  
(11) Alice won't fall/dance, but Bert might do.  
(12) Meat will cost too much, but beans shouldn't do.

This flexibility can be understood in terms of an absence of selectional restrictions. The Voice head realized by British *do* doesn't select for a particular *v* head (such as one specifying [dynamic], [trans], etc.).

Third, Thoms & Walkden (2019) report that British *do* can escape *vP*-preposing.

- (13) a. John said he would win the race, and [<sub>vP</sub> win the race] he will **do**.  
b. John said he would win the race, and [<sub>vP</sub> won the race] he has **done**.  
(Thoms & Walkden 2019: 174)

This compatibility with *vP*-preposing is expected if British *do* is in Voice. *do* isn't part of the *vP* that is targeted (whether by movement, as on a standard movement-based

---

<sup>5</sup>No occurrences are reported in Oger's (2019) analysis of British *do* from the spoken British National Corpus. Thoms & Sailor (2018) report that British *do* is compatible with other "passive-like structures" (Thoms 2019: 1032n.19), as in (i)–(ii) with *get* and Scottish *need*. I leave open how such constructions should be analyzed.

- (i) The cookies definitely won't get eaten, but the cakes might do.  
(ii) The car doesn't need washed now, but it will do by Tuesday. (Scottish English)  
(Thoms & Sailor 2018: n. 5)

analysis, or by ellipsis, as on a matching analysis of the sort advocated by [Thoms & Walkden](#)).<sup>6</sup>

The previous features needn't be unique to an analysis of British *do* as realizing active Voice. For instance, regarding (10)–(12), one could posit that although British *do* is categorially specified as *v*, it is underspecified for features that determine a particular “flavor” of *v*.<sup>7</sup> What is important for present purposes is that a Voice-based analysis of British *do* warrants further investigation. In that spirit, the remainder of the paper begins testing the analyses by examining new data from mismatches under ellipsis.

### 3 Experiments: Mismatches under British *Do* Ellipsis

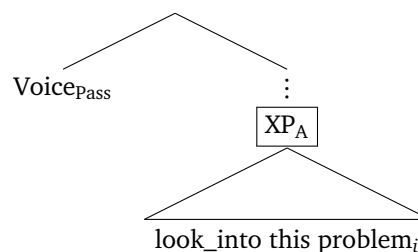
#### 3.1 Background

Traditional verb phrase ellipsis (VPE) tolerates various mismatches between the ellipsis site and the antecedent. In (14) the antecedent-containing clause is passive, while the ellipsis-containing clause is active. (The angled brackets indicate the understood elided material.)

- (14) This problem was to have been looked into, but obviously nobody did.  
       ⟨look into this problem⟩ (Merchant 2013: ex. 2j)

[Merchant \(2013\)](#) appeals to such voice mismatches as evidence that VPE targets a phrase under Voice. Consider the schematic analysis in (15). The contrasting Voice heads are external to the antecedent and elided phrases (written  $XP_A$ ,  $XP_E$ ), hence not part of the material that needs to be relevantly identical for the ellipsis to be licensed. (I leave open where the external argument originates.)

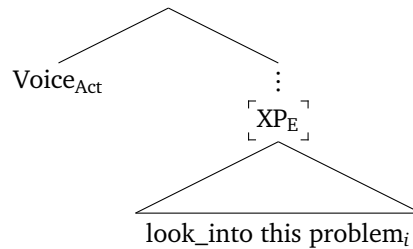
- (15) a. This problem<sub>*i*</sub> was to have been ...



<sup>6</sup>[Thoms & Walkden \(2019: 172–173\)](#) ultimately suggest that vP-preposing in fact targets VoiceP. Such an analysis would also be unproblematic assuming the possibility of movement of Voice into a lower inflectional layer (cf. [Thoms 2011: 11](#)).

<sup>7</sup>While the incompatibility of British *do* with passive *be* is well documented, few accounts offer explanations (see [Baltin 2012: 399, 411–415](#); [Lewis 2022: 5](#)).

b. ... nobody did ...



To assess whether the XP is vP or VP, Merchant considers mismatches in argument structure, as illustrated in (16) with *freeze*. In the first sentence *freeze* occurs in an unaccusative structure in which *this* raises to subject position; in the second sentence *this* occurs as object of *freeze* in a transitive structure.

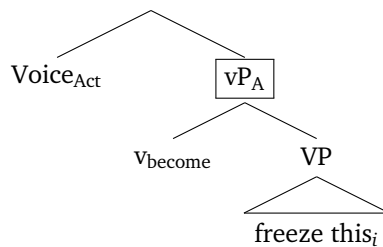
(16) This can freeze. Please freeze this.

Following others in the literature, Merchant observes that such argument structure mismatches are not found under VPE ((17)). This is expected if (i) transitive and unaccusative structures have different v heads (§2), and (ii) VPE targets vP, as reflected in (18). The mismatching v heads violate the identity condition on ellipsis. (To fix ideas, I use  $v_{\text{become}}$  and  $v_{\text{cause}}$  for the different v heads, and I represent the object in VP.)

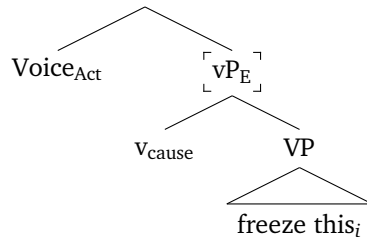
(17) This can freeze. \*Please do.

(Merchant 2013: ex. 30a, following Johnson 2008: ex. 23)

(18) a. This<sub>i</sub> can



b. \*Please do



Suppose Merchant's approach to mismatches under ellipsis is correct. Return to British *do* ellipsis. First, if *do* is in v and the VP elides, argument structure

mismatches should be grammatical. The contrasting features in *v* are external to the ellipsis site and don't bear on the identity condition on ellipsis. But if British *do* realizes Voice, and *vP* elides, argument structure mismatches should be ungrammatical. Second, in both analyses, voice mismatches are expected to be possible.

The data, however, are not straightforward. For instance, Lewis (2022: 6) reports that voice mismatches are “not tolerated” with British *do*, yet provides a judgment of ‘??’ for (19).

(19) ??I thought the books would have been organized by now, but it seems like  
nobody will do. (from Lewis 2022: ex. 35; judgment Lewis's)

This is the only example of mismatches (in voice or argument structure) with British *do* from the literature that I am aware of. A series of experiments were conducted in order to get a more accurate picture of the data.

### 3.2 Experiment 1

First, voice mismatches were examined to test the assumption that British *do* is inside VoiceP (Experiment 1). Participants were 32 native British English speakers, recruited from Prolific and the University of Birmingham. The experiment had a Latin square design with factors for the type of ellipsis (VPE vs. British *do*) and the presence/absence of a voice mismatch. An example illustrating each condition:

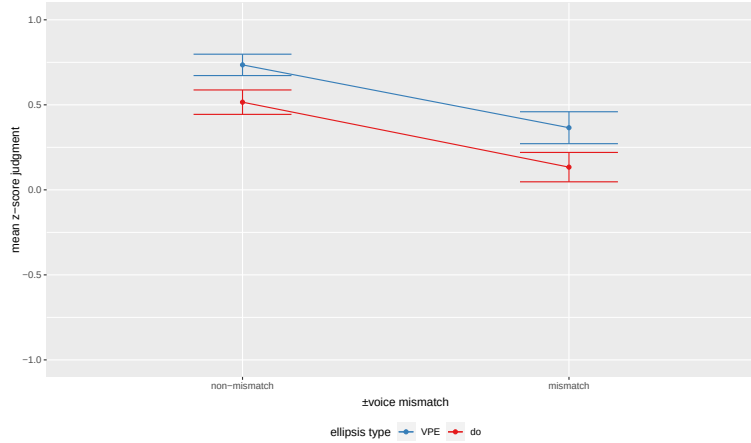
- (20)
- a. Someone should look into the matter, though I doubt anyone will before the meeting. (VPE, –voice.mismatch)
  - b. Someone should look into the matter, though I doubt anyone will do before the meeting. (do.ellipsis, –voice.mismatch)
  - c. The matter should be looked into, though I doubt anyone will before the meeting. (VPE, +voice.mismatch)
  - d. The matter should be looked into, though I doubt anyone will do before the meeting. (do.ellipsis, +voice.mismatch)

8 lexicalizations (tokens) of each sentence type (condition) were distributed among 4 lists via a Latin square procedure, so each participant saw two items for each condition. 4 orders for each list were created and pseudorandomized so that experimental items didn't appear sequentially, yielding 16 surveys in total (2 participants per survey). Each survey included the same (announced and unannounced) practice sentences, filler sentences, and attention checks. The sentences were rated from

1–7. Each participant’s ratings (excluding practice items) were z-score transformed to reduce scale bias.<sup>8</sup>

No evidence was found of a violation from voice mismatches under British *do* ellipsis. A two-factor ANOVA (Ellipsis Type  $\times$  Voice Mismatch) showed essentially no interaction between voice mismatches and British *do* ( $F(1, 27) = 0.005, p = .95$ ). (The simple effect of voice mismatches was significant ( $F(1, 27) = 16.5, p < .001$ ), as was the simple effect of British *do* ( $F(1, 27) = 5.9, p < .05$ ).) The mean z-score rating for sentences with a voice mismatch under British *do* ellipsis, as in (20d), was also positive. The mean non-transformed rating was 5.2 (SEM = .19). An interaction plot illustrating the data is in Figure 1.

**Figure 1:** British *do* & Voice mismatch interaction (Experiment 1)



### 3.3 Experiment 2

The results of Experiment 1 support analyzing British *do* inside VoiceP, given the Merchant-style line of argument from §3.1. A second experiment examined the mismatches in argument structure under British *do* ellipsis to test the analyses of *do* in Voice versus v. 32 native British English speakers were recruited from Prolific to participate (n. 8). The experiment had the same design as above, though now with

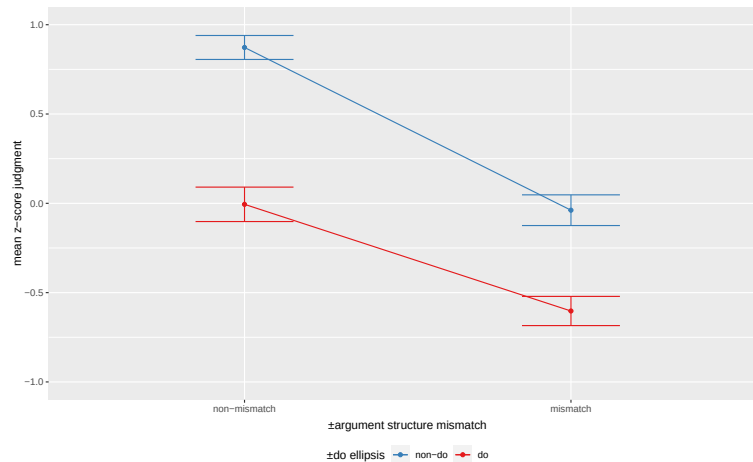
<sup>8</sup>Because of the incompatibility of British *do* with passive *be*, items with a voice mismatch used a passive antecedent and active ellipsis. A set of unrelated “gold standard” sentences with known ratings were included among the fillers and used as a quality check to test for outliers. On this basis, two participants’ responses were removed from the final analysis in Experiment 2, and three participants’ responses were removed in Experiment 3.

factors for the presence/absence of British *do* ellipsis and a mismatch in argument structure. An example of each sentence type is in (21).

- (21) a. The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but they couldn't close it.  
(-do.ellipsis, -arg.mismatch)  
b. The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but they couldn't do.  
(+do.ellipsis, -arg.mismatch)  
c. The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but it wouldn't close.  
(-do.ellipsis, +arg.mismatch)  
d. The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but it wouldn't do. (+do.ellipsis, +arg.mismatch)

The data failed to indicate a violation in sentences with an argument structure mismatch under British *do* ellipsis (cf. (21d)). A two-factor ANOVA (*Do* Ellipsis  $\times$  Argument Structure Mismatch) again showed a significant simple effect of British *do* ( $F(1, 28) = 54.2, p < .0001$ ), and a significant simple effect of a mismatch in argument structure ( $F(1, 28) = 59.2, p < .0001$ ). But their interaction was not significant ( $F(1, 28) = 2.6, p = .12$ ). An interaction plot is in Figure 2. Although

**Figure 2:** British *do* & Argument structure mismatch interaction (Experiment 2)



the mean rating for sentences of the type in (21d) was marginal, the difference from the baseline (cf. (21a)) was in keeping with the negative effects from an argument structure mismatch and from British *do* ellipsis. (The mean *z*-score rating for the baseline sentences with British *do* (cf. (21b)) was itself 0. If anything, using *do*

mitigated some of the negative effect of an argument structure mismatch, though, as noted, the interaction effect was not significant.)

### 3.4 Experiment 3

The previous results were substantiated further by a third experiment, which compared argument structure mismatches under VPE vs. British *do* ellipsis. The experiment had a  $2 \times 2 \times 2$  design with factors for the presence/absence of ellipsis, *do*, and a mismatch in argument structure. The rest of the setup was the same, though now with 8 sentence types (illustrated in (22)), 32 surveys, and 64 participants, again recruited from Prolific (n. 8).

- (22) a. The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but they couldn't (do) close it.  
b. The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but it wouldn't (do) close.  
c. The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but they couldn't (do).  
d. The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but it wouldn't (do).

The complete set of responses was analyzed, along with subsetting data for VPE (i.e., excluding responses for the variants in (22) with *do*) and for British *do* ellipsis (i.e., excluding responses for the ellipsis conditions without *do*).

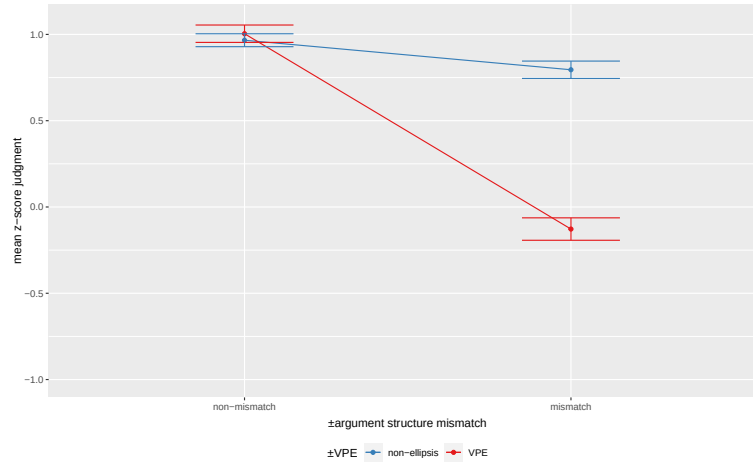
First, the data supported the judgments in the literature of a violation in sentences with an argument structure mismatch under VPE, as in (17) above or (23).

- (23) \*The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but it wouldn't.

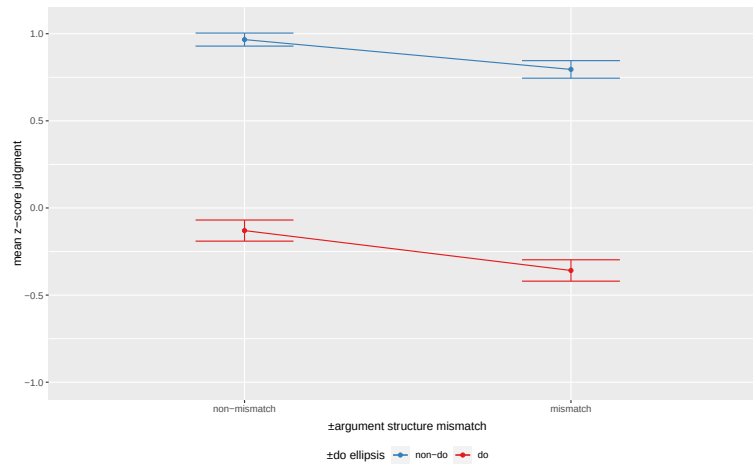
A two-factor ANOVA on the VPE data subset ( $VPE \times$  Argument Structure Mismatch) showed a significant interaction between VPE and a mismatch in argument structure ( $F(1, 57) = 35.4, p < .0001$ ), as reflected in the interaction plot in Figure 3. (The simple effect of VPE was also significant ( $F(1, 57) = 31.5, p < .0001$ ), as was the simple effect of an argument structure mismatch ( $F(1, 57) = 64.5, p < .0001$ ).)

However, as in Experiment 2, the data failed to indicate a violation in sentences with an argument structure mismatch under British *do* ellipsis (cf. (21d)). A two-factor ANOVA on the British *do* data subset ( $Do$  Ellipsis  $\times$  Argument Structure Mismatch) did not show a significant interaction between British *do* and a mismatch in argument structure ( $F(1, 56) = 0.2, p = .67$ ), as is evident from the interaction plot in Figure 4. (The simple effects of British *do* and of an argument structure mismatch were again both significant ( $F(1, 56) = 274.0, p < .0001$ ; and  $F(1, 56) = 8.4, p < .01$ , respectively). As in Experiment 2, the mean rating for the baseline British *do* ellipsis sentences was middling (mean *z*-score  $-0.1$ ), and an argument structure mismatch introduced an additional cost.)

**Figure 3: VPE & Argument structure mismatch interaction**  
(Experiment 3)



**Figure 4: British *do* & Argument structure mismatch interaction**  
(Experiment 3)



Further, a three-factor ANOVA on the complete data set showed the interaction effect between ellipsis and an argument structure mismatch to depend on the presence/absence of *do*. The three-way interaction was significant ( $F(1, 118) = 9.5$ ,  $p < .01$ ). This provides additional evidence for a violation in the one case (VPE) and not the other (British *do* ellipsis).

#### 4 Results: Summary and Discussion

Taken together, the previous experiments provide evidence that British *do* ellipsis elides VP. First, Experiment 1 failed to indicate a grammaticality violation in voice mismatches under British *do* ellipsis, as in (20d) reproduced in (24).

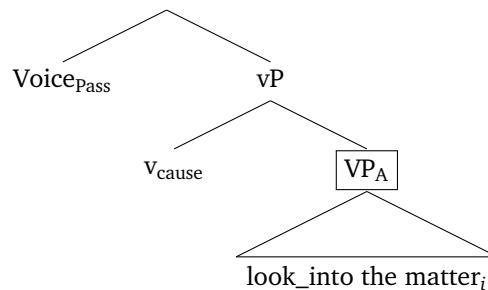
- (24) The matter should be looked into, though I doubt anyone will do before the meeting.

The idea that voice mismatches are “not tolerated” with British *do* (Lewis 2022: 6), in the sense of being ungrammatical, was not substantiated. Second, Experiments 2–3 provided evidence of a violation in argument structure mismatches under VPE, but not under British *do* ellipsis, as indicated in (25).

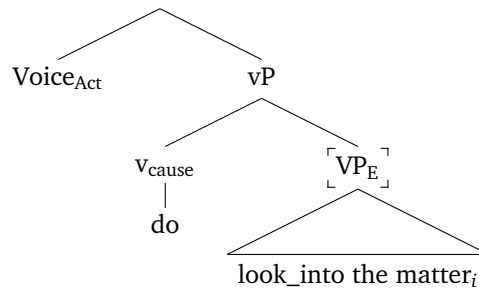
- (25) The travellers tried to close the suitcase, but it wouldn’t \*(do).

These results are expected if British *do* is in *v* and its complement VP is the ellipsis site—again given the assumptions that the identity required for ellipsis is sensitive to syntax, that voice alternations are regulated (partly) by different Voice heads, and that transitive/unaccusative alternations are regulated (partly) by different *v* heads under Voice. In neither voice mismatches nor argument structure mismatches is the head regulating the alternation—Voice or *v*, respectively—in the ellipsis site, as reflected in (26)–(27). (I continue to leave open where external arguments originate.)

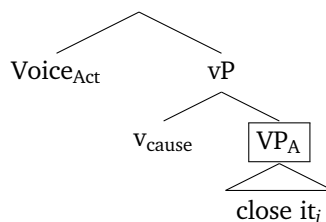
- (26) a. The matter<sub>*i*</sub> should be ...



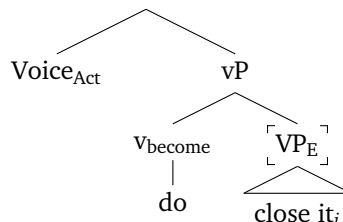
- b. ... anyone will ...



- (27) a. The travellers tried to ...

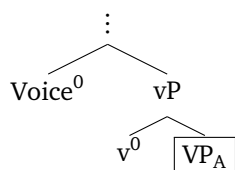


- b. but it<sub>i</sub> wouldn't ...

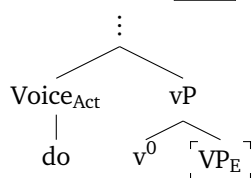


The grammaticality of argument structure mismatches and voice mismatches under British *do* ellipsis supports treating the ellipsis site as VP, under vP and VoiceP. Assuming, as is common, that British *do* is sister to the ellipsis site, this would place British *do* in v. Yet what excludes an analysis in which VP elides and British *do* is in Voice, as schematized in (28)?

- (28) a.

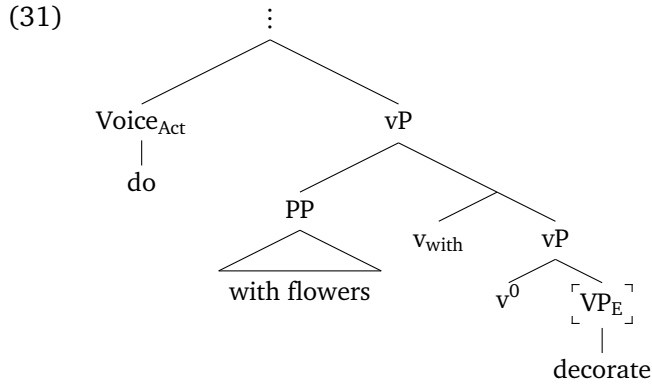


- b.



Absent further constraints, this alternative analysis predicts that British *do* should be able to co-occur with overt material in vP above the ellipsis site. This prediction is not borne out, assuming at least some non-external arguments are introduced in the vP layer. British *do* cannot be followed by the direct object or oblique objects in (29)–(30). A structure such as (31) is illicit.

- (29) I'm not sure if they decorate (cakes) with flowers, but they might do (\*cakes/\*with flowers).  
 (30) I'm not sure if they baked (Pat) cupcakes, but they may have done (\*Pat/\*cupcakes).



As has been observed, British *do* is generally incompatible with material in the verb phrase spelled out to its right (Aelbrecht 2010, Thoms 2011, Baltin 2012). This could be stipulated, though formulating the principle would require care. (For instance, one couldn't simply say that British *do* has an E-feature (Merchant 2001) which triggers ellipsis of its complement.)

Positing a language- or lexically-specific principle is perhaps less ad hoc than it might seem. In other languages that have been argued to have v-/Voice-stranding verb phrase ellipsis, ellipsis is non-obligatory with heads realizing v/Voice. Toosarvandani (2009) observes that light verbs in Persian can be pronounced in verb phrase ellipsis, as in (32) with *dâdan* 'GIVE'. Unlike with British *do*, the ellipsis following Persian light verbs is non-obligatory, as reflected in (33).<sup>9</sup> (Persian is verb-final with a basic SOV word order.)

- (32) Rostam mâshin-esh-o be Sohrâb neshun dâd, vali Râmin  
 Rostam car-his-OBJ to Sohrab showing GIVE.PAST.3SG but Ramin  
 na-dâd.  
 NEG-GIVE.PAST.3SG  
 'Rostam showed his car to Sohrab, but Ramin didn't.'  
 (adapted from Toosarvandani 2009: 65; Persian)

- (33) a. Sohrab piranâ-ro otu ne-mizane, vali Rostam (piranâ-ro  
 Sohrab shirt.PL-OBJ iron NEG-HIT.PRES.3SG but Rostam shirt.PL-OBJ  
 otu) mizane.  
 iron HIT.PRES.3SG  
 'Sohrab won't iron the shirts, but Rostam will (iron the shirts).'  
 (adapted from Toosarvandani 2009: 70; Persian)

<sup>9</sup>Thanks to Reza Hadisi, Mohsen Moghri, and Nader Shoaibi.

- b. Sohrab won't iron the shirts, but Rostam will do (\*iron the shirts).  
(British English)

Persian light verbs have been argued to realize *v* (see also Folli et al. 2005); however, Harley (2017) argues that Persian is a *v*/Voice “bundling” language (Pylkkänen 2008), where the functions of *v* and Voice are combined in a single head and morpheme. This bundling effectively obliterates the distinction being investigated here for British *do*. More detailed comparisons across languages are worth exploring.

## 5 Conclusion

Let's take stock. Arguments from previous literature for treating British *do* in *v* are compatible with an alternative hypothesis that British *do* realizes an active Voice head. This paper has provided experimental evidence from voice mismatches and argument structure mismatches under ellipsis to help distinguish these hypotheses. Though judgments for sentences with an argument structure mismatch under British *do* ellipsis were somewhat marginal, there was not evidence of a grammaticality violation. Taken together, the results support analyzing the ellipsis site in British *do* ellipsis as VP: the heads regulating voice alternations and argument structure alternations are external to the ellipsis site, and thus needn't be identical in order for ellipsis to be licensed. If British *do* is sister to the ellipsis site, as is commonly assumed, British *do* would be in *v*. However, the matter isn't straightforward. One could maintain, for instance, that British *do* realizes active Voice, and posit a principle which prohibits overt material to its right within the verb phrase. Such a principle may be needed for independent reasons.

## References

- Aelbrecht, Lobke. 2010. *The syntactic licensing of ellipsis*. Philadelphia: John Benjamins.
- Baker, C.L. 1984. Two observations on British English *do*. *Linguistic Inquiry* 15: 155–157.
- Baltin, Mark. 2012. Deletion versus pro-forms: An overly simple dichotomy? *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory* 30: 381–423.
- Burzio, Luigi. 1986. *Italian syntax*. Dordrecht: Reidel.
- Chalcraft, Faye. 2006. *Do-doubling in varieties of English*. Paper presented at the Workshop on Syntactic Doubling, Amsterdam.

- Chomsky, Noam. 2001. Derivation by phase. In Michael Kenstowicz (ed.), *Ken Hale: A life in language*, 1–52. Cambridge, Mass.: MIT Press.
- Chomsky, Noam. 2008. On phases. In Robert Freidin, Carlos P. Otero & Maria Luisa Zubizarreta (eds.), *Foundational issues*, 133–166. Cambridge: MIT Press.
- Embick, David & Rolf Noyer. 2001. Movement operations after syntax. *Linguistic Inquiry* 32: 555–595.
- Folli, Raffaella, Heidi Harley & Simin Karimi. 2005. Determinants of event types in Persian complex predicates. *Lingua* 115: 1365–1401.
- Griffiths, James & Marcel den Dikken. 2022. English VP ellipsis in unusual subject configurations: Reviving the Spec–Head agreement approach. In Güliz Güneş & Anikó Lipták (eds.), *The derivational timing of ellipsis*, 97–130. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Haddican, Bill. 2007. The structural deficiency of verbal pro-forms. *Linguistic Inquiry* 38: 539–547.
- Harley, Heidi. 2013. External arguments and the Mirror Principle: On the distinctness of Voice and v. *Lingua* 125: 34–57.
- Harley, Heidi. 2017. The “bundling” hypothesis and the disparate functions of little v. In Roberta D’Alessandro, Irene Franco & Ángel J. Gallego (eds.), *The verbal domain*, 3–28. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Johnson, Kyle. 2008. How to be quiet. In Nikki Adams, Adam Cooper, Fey Parrill & Thomas Wier (eds.), *Proceedings of the Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS) 40-2*, 1–20. Chicago: Chicago Linguistic Society.
- Julien, Marit. 2015. Theme vowels in North Sámi: Spanning and maximal expression. *Lingua* 164: 1–24.
- Lewis, Beccy. 2022. British English *do*-ellipsis is full phase ellipsis. In *Proceedings of the 40th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL 40)*, 1–10. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.
- Merchant, Jason. 2001. *The syntax of silence: Sluicing, islands, and the theory of ellipsis*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Merchant, Jason. 2013. Voice and ellipsis. *Linguistic Inquiry* 44: 77–108.

- Oger, Kimberley. 2019. A study of non-finite forms of anaphoric DO in the spoken BNC. *Anglophonia* 28. <https://doi.org/10.4000/anglophonia.2936>.
- Perlmutter, D. 1983. *Studies in relational grammar*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
- Pylkkänen, Liina. 2008. *Introducing arguments*. Cambridge, Mass.: MIT Press.
- Silk, Alex. 2021. *Semantics with assignment variables*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Stroik, Thomas. 2001. On the light verb hypothesis. *Linguistic Inquiry* 32: 362–369.
- Thoms, Gary. 2011. From economy to locality: *do*-support as head movement. MS, Strathclyde University.
- Thoms, Gary. 2019. Varieties of English. In Jeroen van Craenenbroeck & Tanja Temmerman (eds.), *The Oxford handbook of ellipsis*, 1020–1038. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Thoms, Gary & Craig Sailor. 2018. When silence gets in the way: Extraction from *do*-ellipsis in British dialects. In Sherry Hucklebridge & Max Nelson (eds.), *Proceedings of the 48th annual meeting of the North East Linguistic Society (NELS 48)*, vol. 3, 145–155. Amherst: GLSA Publications.
- Thoms, Gary & George Walkden. 2019. *v*P-fronting with and without remnant movement. *Journal of Linguistics* 55: 161–214.
- Toosarvandani, Maziar. 2009. Ellipsis in Farsi complex predicates. *Syntax* 12: 60–92.